

Industry News

Entry-level handsets sales to grow strongly

As worldwide mobile phones sales begin to rebound after the economic downturn, emerging economies will fuel demand for entry-level handsets—a new ABI Research report finds.

Shipments of ultra-low-cost handsets will grow to more than 360 million by 2015, representing a 2010-15 CAGR of over 22 per cent, while shipments of low-cost handsets will reach 249 million by the same time period. The key markets for these entry-level devices are China, India, Africa, Latin America and some developing economies in Asia.

While many emerging markets have experienced significant increase in the numbers of mobile subscribers, there remains a large portion of the population that is yet to purchase a mobile device or mobile services. Falling prices in this market segment will make mobile phones accessible even to lower-income groups in emerging economies. In addition, features and capabilities of devices in this category continue to improve, delivering a richer and more satisfying end-user experience.

PC majors to drop VGA by 2015

Top PC companies are planning to put digital interfaces such as DisplayPort and high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI) into their computer products. AMD, Dell, Intel, Lenovo, Samsung Electronics LCD Business and LG Display have already announced plans to accelerate adoption of scalable and lower-power digital interfaces.

Intel and AMD expect that analogue display outputs such as video graphics array (VGA) and the low-voltage differential signaling technology (LVDS) panel interface would no longer be supported in their product lines by 2015. HDMI is increasingly

Chopra named MD of Philips Electronics

In a top-level management change, the Philips board has appointed Rajeev Chopra as the managing director of Philips Electronics India Limited. Chopra will combine this new role with his current position as head of Philips Lighting India until his successor is appointed. Muri Sivaraman, the current head of Philips' Indian electronics division, will now head the global domestic appliances business of the group. He will be based out of Shanghai in China.

LG India too gets new MD

LG Electronics has appointed Soon H. Kwon as the new managing director of

its India operations. Kwon will replace Moon B. Shin, who will take over as the global head-sales and marketing, home appliances, at LG Electronics' headquarter in Seoul, South Korea. Although a couple of Indian executives at LG were believed to be contenders for the top job, Kwon's appointment proves that the company is not yet ready to appoint an Indian for the country head's role.

Kwon—the company's third Korean chief in 14 years—served as the managing director at LGE Australia in 2009. One of the top contributors to LG's international business for over 25 years, he has been responsible for the company's growing revenue and building LG Business Solutions Korea as a leading B2B supplier.

being included in new PCs for easy connection to consumer electronics devices. DisplayPort is expected to become the single PC digital display output for embedded flat panels, PC monitors and projectors.

DisplayPort and HDMI allow for slimmer laptop designs and support higher resolutions with deeper colour than VGA—a technology which is more than 20 years old. Additionally, as laptops become smaller and their embedded flat-panel resolutions increase for more immersive experience, the power advantages, bidirectional communications and design efficiency benefits of DisplayPort make it a superior choice over LVDS—the previous standard for LCD panel inputs.

Connected e-reader sales grow 80 per cent

Market research analyst Gartner estimates worldwide connected e-reader sales to total 6.6 million units in 2010—up 79.8 per cent from 2009 sales of 3.6 million units. In 2011,

worldwide e-reader sales are projected to surpass eleven million units—a 68.3 per cent increase from 2010.

e-readers are portable devices that use an e-ink, e-paper or similar display technology. "The connected e-reader market has grown dramatically during the past two years, driven by sales of Amazon's e-readers, primarily in North America. This is the dominant region for e-reader sales, and we predict that it will account for sales of just over four million units in 2010," said Hugues De La Vergne, principal research analyst at Gartner. North America will remain a key market through 2014, although its dominance will decline significantly as regions such as Western Europe and Asia/Pacific become the leading locations for growth. Growth



The Skill reader